

Mouloud Mammeri University

Department of Sciences

Module: Technical English – L1 Computer Science

Session 6: Computer Files

Technical Vocabulary

- **File** – Fichier. Example: *text.txt*
- **Folder / Directory** – Dossier / Répertoire. Example: *Documents, Downloads*
- **File extension** – Extension de fichier. Example: *.txt, .pdf, .jpg*
- **Executable** – Fichier exécutable. Example: *program.exe*
- **Text file** – Fichier texte. Example: *notes.txt*
- **Image file** – Fichier image. Example: *photo.jpg, image.png*
- **Audio file** – Fichier audio. Example: *song.mp3*
- **Video file** – Fichier vidéo. Example: *movie.mp4*
- **Compressed file** – Fichier compressé. Example: *archive.zip*
- **Path** – Chemin d'accès. Example: *C:\Users\Nassima\Documents*
- **Root directory** – Répertoire racine. Example: *C:*
- **Subdirectory** – Sous-dossier. Example: *Documents, Projects*
- **Encrypted file** – Fichier crypté / protégé par mot de passe. Example: *secret.zip*
- **Temporary file** – Fichier temporaire. Example: *temp.tmp*
- **Backup** – Sauvegarde. Example: *backup.docx*
- **Shortcut / Link** – Raccourci / Lien. Example: *shortcut.lnk*
- **Hidden file** – Fichier caché. Example: *.htaccess*

Common File Types

- **Documents:** .docx, .pdf, .txt, .odt
- **Images:** .jpg, .png, .gif, .bmp, .svg
- **Audio / Video:** .mp3, .wav, .mp4, .avi, .mkv
- **Compressed files:** .zip, .rar, .7z, .tar.gz
- **Executable files:** .exe, .bat, .sh
- **Programming files:** .c, .cpp, .java, .py, .html, .css, .js

File Path

A file path is the address that specifies the exact location of a file or folder in a computer's file system. It shows how to reach the file by listing the directories from the root (or current directory) to the file name.

Absolute and Relative Paths

Absolute Path

An **absolute path** is the complete path to a file or folder, starting from the root directory of the system. It shows the exact location of the file and does not depend on the current directory.

Characteristics:

- Always starts from the root directory
- Independent of the current working directory
- Always points to the same location

Examples:

- Windows: C:\Users\Nassima\Documents\File.txt
- Linux: /home/nassima/Documents/file.txt

Technical sentence: "This file is accessed using an absolute path."

Relative Path

A **relative path** specifies the location of a file or folder relative to the current directory. It does not start from the root directory.

Characteristics:

- Depends on the current directory
- Shorter and easier to write
- Commonly used in projects and scripts

Special symbols:

- `.` → current directory
- `..` → parent directory

Example: If the current directory is:

```
C:\Users\Nassima\Documents
```

Then the relative path:

```
..\Pictures\image.jpg
```

means: move up one directory, then enter the Pictures folder.

Technical sentence: “This file is accessed using a relative path.”

Compressed Files and Security

Why Use Compressed Files

- Reduce file size for storage or Internet transfer
- Group multiple files in a single archive
- Facilitate backup or transfer

Common formats: `.zip`, `.rar`, `.7z`, `.tar.gz`

Encrypted Files

- Compressed files can be protected with a password
- Example: secret.zip requires a password to open
- Protects sensitive data

Security Tips

- Never open a file with an unknown extension
- Verify the sender before downloading a file
- Use strong passwords for sensitive files
- Keep antivirus software updated
- Do not execute files from unknown sources (.exe, .bat, .sh)

Useful Phrases for Files

- Open the file → Ouvrir le fichier
- Save the document → Enregistrer le document
- Copy the folder to another directory → Copier le dossier dans un autre répertoire
- The file is in the root directory → Le fichier se trouve dans le répertoire racine
- Check the file extension before opening → Vérifie l'extension avant d'ouvrir
- Compress the folder into a zip file → Compresser le dossier dans un fichier zip
- Encrypt the file with a password → Protéger le fichier avec un mot de passe
- Move the file to the backup folder → Déplacer le fichier dans le dossier de sauvegarde
- Delete temporary files → Supprimer les fichiers temporaires